Semicorn

"India Has **Significant Demand,** So Why Not Produce **Indian Chips?**"

From Tata to Tech Trailblazer: Raja Manickam's blueprint is for turning India into a global semiconductor leader through local innovation and talent

Raja Manickam, touted as one of the brains behind Tata Group's semiconductor foray, parted ways with the group early this year. He is now busy setting up a fabless semiconductor company in India and focusing on "creating demand in the country."

He says, "I am confident that in five years, India will be a major player in exporting electronics, including inverters and EV chargers. The Indian companies I am collaborating with today will be the ones propelling me onto the global stage in five years."

Additionally, he believes that Indian companies are always Tier III for semiconductor "big boys." At his newly minted enterprise, IVP Semiconductor, Indian companies will always maintain their place as Tier I partners. Interesting excerpts from the interaction with Raja Manickam:

Why did Raja Manickam part ways with Tata Group?

Tata is an excellent company to work with. They have grand plans, and I accomplished what I set out to achieve when I joined them. I was among the first few individuals to conceptualise Tata's semiconductor plans. There came a time when I wanted to contribute more to India's semiconductor mission from an external perspective. I have always been an entrepreneur and have a penchant for expeditious action. I firmly believe in creating opportunities for others.

In that sense, I established opportunities and raised awareness for the Tata Group, which is now primarily focused on execution. I am also actively involved in other semiconductor projects in India now.

Apart from these projects, what else are you doing now?

I am concentrating on stimulating demand for what we 'Make in India.' The dialogue has largely revolved around 'Making Semiconductors in India,' but someone needs to address the demand side of the equation. I have taken it upon myself because once there's sufficient demand, manufacturing will naturally follow. My current mission is to generate that demand.

How will you approach this?

There are several facets to it. I am establishing a new fabless chip company that focuses on the power market. These are fundamental and essential analogue components required for a broad range of applications, including solar, renewables, EVs, consumer electronics, IoT, and all things power-related.

To put it simply, I'm compiling a catalogue of essential products and solutions. These core offerings will underpin India's transition from fossil fuels to clean energy.

Isn't the demand already there?

While there is indeed demand, it currently represents only a fraction of what it will be in the years to come. Furthermore, this demand is currently being met by major international players located outside India. My standpoint is that I am an Indian company, and India has significant demand, so why not produce Indian chips?

From a philosophical perspective, we've seen that the Chinese prefer Chinese products, Europeans opt for European offerings, and so on, as long as the capabilities are present. I don't see any reason India should be different.

So, will your new company create this demand?

Yes and no. We will officially unveil our new company in December